economic interaction and diplomatic co-operation between India and China have increased. Modi's China policy is thus somewhat complex, involving a mixture of cooperation and confrontation.

The international relations (IR) concepts of balancing or bandwagoning cannot sufficiently explain India's actions and policies vis-à-vis China. According to IR theory, a state facing a shift in a balance of power or a threat can choose either to act aggressively, to "balance" the threat, or can seek greater cooperation, thus "bandwagoning." Modi's government, however, appears to be doing a bit of both, simultaneously adopting tactics of cooperation and confrontation. Clearly, the concepts of balancing[1] and bandwagoning[2] require refinement, as scholarly discussions within the IR community in recent years have suggested. Adam P. Liff argues that in order to identify balancing behaviour, looking at pure defence expenditures in relation to gross domestic product (GDP) (for internal balancing) and formal military alliances (for external balancing) is insufficient.[3] According to Liff, to assess efforts to enhance internal capabilities, it is necessary to take into account indicators such as changes to the force structure and force posture; strategies and doctrines; budgets; new weapons platforms and technologies; developments in new domains, such as space and cyber; joint operational capabilities; and procurement plans. Assessing external measures requires consideration of things such as joint training and command centres, development of joint doctrines and security partnerships, co-location of forces, the establishment of new bases, and formal alliances.[4]

A possible alternative concept for understanding state behaviour is "hedging." As defined by Koga and Tunsjø and applied by the editors of this volume, hedging offers a wider spectrum of alignment policy options than just the two extremes of balancing and bandwagoning.[5] By dividing